

Akanksha Bhand

Senior Project & Delivery Manager | Banking Transformation | SWIFT | ISO 20022 | Transaction Banking

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Summary

Senior Project & Delivery Manager with 13+ years of IT experience, including 8+ years leading complex banking transformation initiatives across Custody, Transaction Banking, Payments, Cash Management and Commercial Banking. Experienced in delivering regulatory, SWIFT and ISO 20022 transformation programs, driving business and technology alignment, Agile delivery, governance, financial management and stakeholder engagement. Strong techno-functional expertise with a proven ability to lead cross-functional teams from project initiation through production deployment and hypercare.

Core Competencies

Project & Delivery Management • Program Governance • PMO • RACI & Accountability Management • People & Resource Transition • Workforce Planning • SWIFT Messaging • ISO 20022 Migration

• Transaction Banking • Payments • Cash Management • Custody • Regulatory Change Delivery • Process Transition • Shared Resource Management

• Agile / Scrum / SAgE • Release & Cutover Management • RAID Management • Budget & Financial Governance • Executive Reporting • Vendor Management • Stakeholder Management • Mainframe Modernization • JIRA • Confluence • MS Project

Professional Experience

Bank of New York Mellon | Project Manager | Oct 2021 – Present

- Lead end-to-end delivery of strategic transformation initiatives across Custody Services, Transaction Banking, Payments and Cash Management.
- Manage SWIFT transformation initiatives including ISO 20022 adoption, structured address migration, payment message enhancements and regulatory compliance projects.
- Coordinate business, operations, architecture, development, QA and production support teams to deliver regulatory milestones within committed timelines.
- Define and maintain RACI matrices across Business, Operations, Architecture, Technology, Risk and Compliance teams, establishing clear ownership, accountability and decision-making responsibilities across transformation workstreams.
- Conduct requirement elicitation workshops, impact assessments and solution discussions with business and technology stakeholders.
- Translate business requirements into epics, user stories and acceptance criteria while partnering with Product Owners during backlog refinement.
- Lead Sprint Planning, Daily Stand-ups, Sprint Reviews and Retrospectives, ensuring sprint commitments align with programme milestones.
- Own integrated project plans, milestones, dependencies, RAID logs, change requests and overall delivery governance.
- Track project financials, resource capacity, forecasting and budget utilisation while providing regular

executive updates.

- Lead people and resource transition activities across project workstreams, including resource planning, role alignment, capacity management, knowledge transfer and transition of responsibilities to ensure continuity of business and technology operations.
- Manage shared-resource dependencies across interconnected banking applications and delivery teams, coordinating resource movement, responsibilities and timelines to minimise transition and delivery risks.
- Prepare Steering Committee presentations highlighting delivery health, milestone status, risks, issues, dependencies and mitigation plans.
- Drive cross-functional dependency management across upstream and downstream banking applications, interfaces and SWIFT integrations.
- Lead SIT, UAT, production readiness reviews, release planning, cutover execution and post-production hypercare.
- Lead business and process transition activities through readiness planning, stakeholder alignment, role and accountability changes, knowledge transfer, cutover and post-production stabilisation.
- Collaborate with Compliance, Risk and Business teams to ensure regulatory commitments are delivered on time with appropriate governance.
- Leverage AI-enabled reporting and delivery dashboards to improve delivery visibility, executive reporting and decision-making.
- Mentor project teams, facilitate issue resolution and promote Agile best practices across distributed delivery teams.

Stakeholder & Business Engagement

- Act as the primary liaison between Business, Product Owners, Operations, Architecture and Technology teams, ensuring business objectives are translated into executable delivery plans.
- Conduct daily interactions with business stakeholders to clarify requirements, discuss project progress, resolve functional queries and proactively manage delivery expectations.
- Facilitate business requirement workshops, impact assessment sessions and solution walkthroughs to align regulatory and business requirements with technical implementation.
- Partner with Product Owners and business users during backlog refinement, prioritization and sprint planning to maximize business value.
- Present project status, milestone progress, risks, dependencies and mitigation plans to senior business stakeholders through governance forums and Steering Committee meetings.
- Support SIT, UAT, production readiness and post-production validation activities with business stakeholders to ensure successful business sign-off.
- Manage changing business priorities through impact analysis, change control and close coordination with delivery teams.
- Build trusted relationships with business stakeholders through transparent communication, proactive issue resolution and regular executive updates.

Key Projects

- SWIFT & ISO 20022 Regulatory Transformation

Managed delivery planning for payment messaging enhancements supporting evolving SWIFT standards, structured address adoption, regulatory compliance and enterprise integration across multiple banking platforms.

- Custody & Transaction Banking Transformation

Delivered initiatives supporting custody operations, payment processing, cash management capabilities and enterprise banking modernization.

Nihilent Technologies | Project Manager / Technical Delivery Manager | Oct 2018 – Oct 2021

- Led delivery of core banking transformation programmes for commercial banking clients.
- Managed a cross-functional team of 17 members across development, QA and production support.
- Owned project planning, governance, RAID management, stakeholder communication and delivery reporting.
- Partnered with business teams for requirements clarification, prioritisation and release planning.
- Facilitated Agile ceremonies and ensured successful sprint execution and timely delivery.
- Managed project financials, forecasting, risks, resource planning and vendor coordination.
- Presented project status to senior stakeholders and drove issue resolution through governance forums.

Earlier Experience

Capgemini India – Consultant (HSBC Transaction Services & HSBCNet Payments) Hewlett Packard
Enterprise – Senior Software Engineer

Tata Consultancy Services – System Engineer

Built a strong foundation in commercial banking, payments, lending, mortgages, healthcare and enterprise mainframe technologies before progressing into Project & Delivery Management roles.

Technical & Domain Expertise

Banking Domains: Custody, Transaction Banking, Payments, Cash Management, Commercial Banking, Consumer Lending, Capital Markets.

Technologies: COBOL, JCL, CICS, DB2, VSAM, MQ, Java, REXX, Z/OS.

Tools: JIRA, Confluence, MS Project, FileAid, Endeavor, Topaz, CA7.

Certifications

- Certified Scrum Master
- SAFe Agile
- Foundation Certificate in Banking
- Capital Markets
- Consumer Lending
- Bank Credit
- Canadian Banking
- IBM DB2 Fundamentals

Awards

- Star of the Month
- Innovators at Heart
- TCS On-the-Spot Award

- TCS GEMS Best Team Award
- Multiple Client Appreciation Awards

Education

Bachelor of Engineering, Government Engineering College, Ujjain